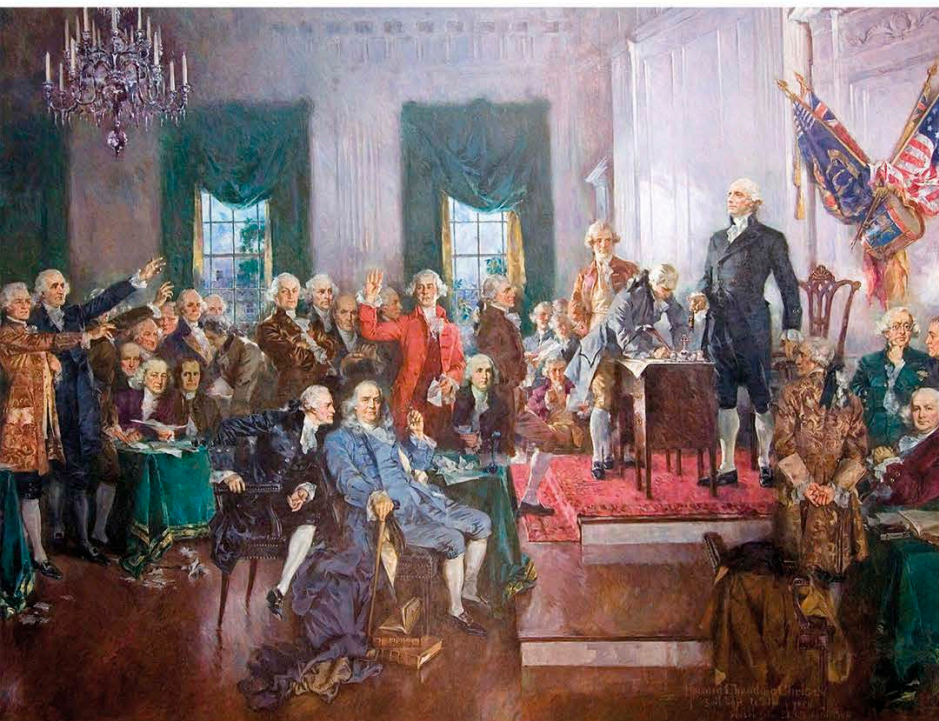


American independence

In the 18th century, the American Revolution began when the Thirteen Colonies in North America staged an uprising against British colonial rule. The British had introduced new taxes on goods imported to the colonies, such as sugar and tea, which the colonists felt were deeply unfair. Tensions escalated, and war broke out on April 19, 1775, with the battles of Lexington and Concord, both victories for the colonists. The following year, on July 4, the colonists declared their independence from Britain, forming the United States of America. After eight years of warfare, in 1783 the British were finally defeated, and the fight for independence was won.



▲ SIGNING THE CONSTITUTION

Following the Revolutionary War, people from the thirteen newly independent states gathered to create an official Constitution for the new country. This groundbreaking document was agreed upon and signed in 1787. It laid the foundations for law and government in the United States, while also protecting the freedoms of white male American citizens.

CROSSING THE ICY DELAWARE

On the night of December 25–26, 1776, American general George Washington (center) secretly led his troops by boat across the Delaware River near New Jersey. On reaching the other side, they targeted unsuspecting German troops who had been hired to help the British. The surprise attack was a success, and gave the Americans an early advantage, and helped raise the American troops' morale.

